



PILOT DUE DILIGENCE REPORT: GATHER FOODS / WEITJ INVESTMENTS

Assessment Date: October 27, 2025

Location: Perth, Western Australia

Relationship Status: Ex-client, personal connection (friend of husband), prior job offer extended

Recent Engagement: "We need to talk" message last week, followed by no follow-up (ghosting pattern continues)

CLIENT DETAILS

Organization: Gather Foods / Weitj Investments Group

Managing Director: Gerry Matera (Nyoongar entrepreneur, cultural leader, international speaker) ^[1] ^[2]

Business Structure: Aboriginal-owned conglomerate spanning:

- **Gather Foods** – Native food manufacturing, catering, events, B2B supply ^[2]
- **Eon Protection** – Security services (20+ years operational) ^[2]
- **Indigenous Defence Services** – Defence & infrastructure project support ^[2]
- **Gather Foundation** – Social enterprise, cultural impact programs ^[3] ^[4]

Core Mission: Elevate Aboriginal voices through industry participation, authentic native food experiences, cultural governance, and intergenerational wealth-building ^[1] ^[2]

Market Position: Leading WA Aboriginal food/catering brand; national supplier to corporates, retailers, events; high cultural credibility; recent Gather Foundation Gala (October 2025) demonstrated scale and community profile ^[5] ^[6] ^[7]

OVERALL PILOT SCORE

7.2/10 ■ **YELLOW – HIGH POTENTIAL, HIGH ENGAGEMENT RISK**

Tier Classification: High-Value Pilot with Execution Uncertainty

COMPETITIVE COMPARISON [TO OTHER PILOTS]

Factor	Gather Foods/Weitj	Sevenoaks Catering	Maana Living	Indicator
Relationship Depth	Very High – ex-client, job offer, personal tie	High – direct referral, responsive	Medium – cold, professional	▯ Green
Digital Maturity	Low-Medium – manual ops, no automation	Medium – some digital, open to upgrade	Medium-High – tech-forward STR platform	▯ Yellow
Engagement Pattern	Poor – repeated ghosting despite interest signals	Strong – proactive meetings	Medium – cautious, responsive	▯ Red
Conglomerate Fit	Excellent – cross-vertical (food, security, defence, foundation)	Medium – single vertical (catering only)	Medium – single vertical (accommodation)	▯ Green
Mission Alignment	Perfect – Indigenous/WA digital uplift is your core "why"	Medium – business efficiency focus	Low – commercial ROI only	▯ Green
Booking/Order Pain	High – seasonal event surges, B2B wholesale orders, missed calls	High – event bookings, dietary inquiries	Medium – automated via platform but high call volume	▯ Green
Cultural/Compliance Value	Very High – PRIS Act, Indigenous procurement, WA data sovereignty	Low – standard SME compliance	Low – standard STR compliance	▯ Green
Scale/Revenue Upside	Very High – multi-brand group, national reach, government tenders	Medium – regional catering market	Medium-High – 50+ properties, expanding	▯ Green
Staff Capacity	Low – founder extremely busy, stretched ops team	Medium – co-founder available, clear process owner	High – dedicated ops manager	▯ Red
Grant/Funding Leverage	Very High – Indigenous business, multiple WA/Federal programs eligible	Medium – standard SME grants	Medium – tourism/tech grants	▯ Green

WEB ANALYSIS

Conducted: Yes

Key Findings:

- Gather Foods maintains active social presence, regularly posts events, Perth Mint functions, and Gather Foundation gala (October 2025) [\[6\]](#) [\[7\]](#) [\[5\]](#)
- Weitj Investments articulates sophisticated cultural mission and conglomerate strategy, but digital footprint shows limited automation/tech adoption [\[1\]](#) [\[2\]](#)

- Gerry Matera's LinkedIn profile emphasizes Aboriginal economic development, procurement strategy, and multi-sector capability—indicating strategic sophistication but high workload^[2]
- Recent major event (Gather Foundation Gala – "Making Fire" theme, October 2025) demonstrates operational scale and brand strength but also confirms periods of extreme founder/team busyness^[7] ^[6]
- No evidence of current voice agent, chatbot, or booking automation on website or social channels^[8] ^[9]

Validation: High need for automation confirmed; digital gap is real and costing missed orders/bookings, especially during event/seasonal peaks^[10] ^[11]

PILOT VIABILITY

Verdict: VIABLE – IF ENGAGEMENT CONVERTS

Technical Fit: Excellent (9/10)

Strategic Fit: Excellent (9.5/10)

Mission Fit: Perfect (10/10)

Execution Risk: Very High (3/10)

Most Dangerous Assumption:

Gerry will prioritize pilot activation despite repeated pattern of interest signals followed by non-response. The "we need to talk" message last week without follow-up is a **critical red flag** that bandwidth/priority misalignment persists.

Validation Test Required:

Send research brief + demo link with **no meeting required**. If zero response within 7 days, deprioritize and redirect effort to higher-conversion pilots.

QUICK PROFILE SUMMARY

Gather Foods/Weitj Investments is WA's leading Aboriginal-owned food and service conglomerate, combining catering, native food supply, security, defence services, and social enterprise under visionary leadership. They operate at the intersection of cultural mission, commercial scale, and government/corporate procurement—making them an ideal voice agent pilot for both impact and market validation. However, founder bandwidth constraints and repeated engagement lapses create high execution uncertainty despite perfect strategic alignment. Your personal history (job offer, ex-client status, shared mission) provides unique access but has not yet translated to pilot commitment.

BREAKDOWN

STRENGTHS

1. Conglomerate Scale & Cross-Vertical Opportunity

Voice agent can serve Gather Foods (catering, wholesale orders, event inquiries), Eon Protection (security quote requests), Indigenous Defence Services (tender inquiries), and Gather Foundation (donor/volunteer intake)—making this a multi-use case pilot with compounding ROI ^[10] ^[2]

2. Perfect Mission Alignment

Your "why" for starting Good AI Australia—elevating WA Aboriginal SMEs through accessible AI—directly matches Weitj's core purpose ^[12] ^[1]

3. Cultural & Procurement Differentiator

First WA/Aboriginal food business to deploy PRIS-compliant, culturally safe AI automation—positioning for government tenders, Supply Nation certification, and media/PR as sector leader ^[4] ^[12]

4. High Pain Point Severity

Seasonal event surges (e.g., Gather Foundation Gala, corporate catering bookings) create missed call/order scenarios; B2B wholesale inquiries require 24/7 availability; dietary/cultural food questions need expert-level responses ^[11] ^[5] ^[6] ^[10]

5. Grant & Funding Eligibility

Weitj entities qualify for Indigenous business grants, WA digital transformation co-funding, and federal programs—de-risking pilot investment and enabling scale ^[13] ^[12]

6. Established Trust & Credibility

Job offer history proves Gerry values your strategic thinking; personal connection (husband's friend) provides access other vendors lack ^[14] ^[15] ^[16]

7. Benchmark Against Proven Pilots

Your "Handsome Catering" template (built for Gather context) already exists; Sevenoaks Catering pilot showed >30% reduction in missed bookings, validating catering sector ROI ^[17] ^[14] ^[10]

CONCERNS

1. Chronic Engagement Inertia

Pattern of "ghosting" despite stated interest ("we need to talk" last week, then silence) signals either bandwidth overload, competing priorities, or misalignment between stated intent and actual urgency

2. Founder Bandwidth Constraints

Gerry operates across 4+ entities, recent major event (Gather Foundation Gala), and national Indigenous business advocacy—leaving minimal capacity for new project onboarding ^[6] ^[2]

3. Digital Adoption Skepticism

Low baseline digital maturity may create friction in pilot execution, requiring more hand-holding and change management than anticipated ^[10]

4. Risk of "Friend Tax"

Personal relationship may create expectation of free/discounted service or informal "help me out" framing rather than professional pilot engagement

5. No Internal Champion Identified

Unclear who inside Weitj/Gather would own pilot implementation if Gerry remains unavailable (operations manager? admin lead?)

6. Seasonal Timing Risk

Approaching peak event/holiday season (Nov-Dec 2025) may delay pilot activation until Q1 2026, reducing urgency

RED FLAGS

1. Repeated "We Need to Talk" Pattern with No Follow-Through

Last week's message is part of a recurring cycle—creates false momentum, wastes your prep time, and signals lack of genuine decision-making authority or priority

2. Prior Job Offer Context May Create Confusion

Gerry may perceive you as "inside ally" rather than external vendor, blurring commercial boundaries and delaying formal engagement

3. No Clear Procurement Process

Conglomerate structure without defined digital/tech procurement pathway may mean indefinite "exploratory" phase with no contract pathway

4. Risk of Being Perceived as "All Talk"

Despite job offer, Gerry may not have seen tangible proof of your technical execution capability—your research may be first real evidence, but only if he reads it

RISK MATRIX

Risk	Severity	Likelihood	Mitigation Strategy
Engagement Drop-Off (Ghosting)	Very High	Very High	Send research brief + demo link requiring zero meeting commitment ; set 7-day response deadline, then deprioritize if no action
Founder Bandwidth Overload	High	Very High	Identify operational champion (admin manager, ops lead) as pilot owner; reduce Gerry's involvement to approval-only
"Friend Tax" / Free Work Expectation	Medium	Medium	Frame proposal as commercial pilot with clear scope, timeline, and investment (or grant-funded); emphasize ROI metrics from other pilots
Digital Adoption Resistance	Medium	Medium	Lead with "set-and-forget" automation messaging; cite Sevenoaks pilot (30% missed call reduction) as peer proof ^[14]
Perception of "All Talk, No Execution"	High	High	Lead with demo-first , not pitch-first; "Handsome Catering" agent already built—send live test link

Risk	Severity	Likelihood	Mitigation Strategy
Seasonal Timing Delays Pilot	Medium	High	Position as "pre-Christmas surge solution"—urgency messaging around Nov-Dec event season
Cultural/IP Trust Concerns	Medium	Low-Medium	Explicitly address PRIS Act compliance, WA data sovereignty, Aboriginal IP control in brief ^[4] ^[12]

PROS & CONS

PROS

- ✓ **Perfect strategic, cultural, and mission alignment** – best-fit pilot in your portfolio
- ✓ **Conglomerate scale = multiple use cases, compounding ROI** across 4+ entities
- ✓ **WA/Aboriginal "first mover" positioning** – PR, grants, procurement leverage
- ✓ **Established trust & personal relationship** – rare access for SME vendor
- ✓ **High pain point severity** – seasonal booking surges, B2B wholesale, 24/7 inquiry needs
- ✓ **Grant/co-funding eligibility** – de-risks pilot investment
- ✓ **Proven template exists** – "Handsome Catering" agent ready to deploy
- ✓ **Research directly exposes strategic gaps** – demonstrates your value beyond "tech vendor"

CONS

- ✗ **Chronic engagement inertia** – repeated ghosting pattern despite interest signals
- ✗ **Founder bandwidth overload** – extremely busy, no clear internal champion
- ✗ **Risk of indefinite "exploratory" phase** – no clear procurement/approval pathway
- ✗ **"Friend tax" risk** – personal relationship may blur commercial boundaries
- ✗ **Low digital maturity baseline** – may require more change management than anticipated
- ✗ **Seasonal timing** – approaching peak Nov-Dec event season may delay activation
- ✗ **Unproven execution credibility** – Gerry may not yet perceive you as technical implementer

STRATEGY & PITCH

HOOK

*"You trusted me enough to offer me a job. I turned it down to build something bigger—not just for me, but for **you**. Here's the proof: a ready-to-deploy solution that fixes every booking, order, and compliance gap across your entire group. No meeting required—just read this, test the demo, and let me know if you want it live before Christmas."*

VALUE PROPOSITION

For Gather Foods: 24/7 automated booking, event inquiry handling, dietary/cultural food questions, wholesale order capture—reducing missed calls by 30%+ (proven in Sevenoaks pilot)^[14]

For Weitj Conglomerate: Single voice agent platform serving Gather Foods, Eon Protection, Indigenous Defence Services, and Gather Foundation—cross-vertical efficiency at scale

For WA/Aboriginal Leadership: First PRIS-compliant, culturally safe AI automation for Indigenous food/service business—unlocking government tenders, Supply Nation visibility, and sector PR^[4] ^[12]

For Gerry Personally: Free up your time by automating routine inquiries across all entities; focus on strategic leadership, not admin fire-fighting

PILOT SCOPE

Phase 1 (14 days):

- Deploy "GatherVoice" agent for Gather Foods inbound calls (bookings, events, wholesale inquiries)
- Integrate with existing phone number(s), no website/CRM changes required
- Test with internal team + select high-volume client scenarios

Phase 2 (30 days):

- Expand to Eon Protection (quote requests), Indigenous Defence Services (tender inquiries), Gather Foundation (donor/volunteer intake)
- Capture baseline vs. AI performance data: call completion rate, error reduction, after-hours order capture

Success Criteria:

- 30%+ reduction in missed calls/orders (benchmark: Sevenoaks pilot)^[14]
- 15+ hours/week admin time saved across group
- Zero cultural/compliance incidents (PRIS Act, data sovereignty validated)
- Positive client feedback (NPS >8/10)

SUCCESS METRICS

1. **Call Completion Rate:** % of inbound calls handled end-to-end by AI (target: 70%+)
2. **Missed Order Reduction:** % decrease in missed bookings/wholesale orders vs. baseline (target: 30%+)
3. **Staff Hours Saved:** Weekly admin time freed up (target: 15+ hours)
4. **After-Hours Capture:** % of orders/bookings captured outside business hours (new revenue)
5. **Client Satisfaction:** NPS score from actual Gather/Weitj clients (target: 8+/10)
6. **Compliance Validation:** Zero data/cultural incidents; PRIS Act audit-ready^[4]
7. **Grant/Procurement Win:** Tender or funding application strengthened by AI capability (qualitative)

IMPACTFUL AREAS

Operational Impact:

- Eliminate seasonal booking bottlenecks (e.g., pre-Christmas event surge, Gather Foundation Gala inquiries)
- 24/7 wholesale order capture for B2B clients (national retailers, corporates)
- Reduce founder/senior staff admin burden—focus on growth, not phone tag

Strategic Impact:

- WA/Aboriginal "digital first mover" positioning—media, PR, sector case study
- Strengthen government tender applications (digital capability, data sovereignty compliance) ^[12] ^[4]
- De-risk expansion (new markets, new entities) with scalable automation backbone

Financial Impact:

- Capture after-hours/missed revenue (estimated 15-20% uplift based on catering sector benchmarks) ^[11] ^[10]
- Reduce admin/staffing costs (15+ hours/week = ~\$15K-\$20K annual savings)
- Unlock grant/co-funding pathways (WA digital transformation, Indigenous business programs) ^[13] ^[12]

Cultural Impact:

- Model culturally safe, PRIS-compliant AI for Aboriginal businesses—sector leadership
- Empower staff with AI tools (not replacement)—upskilling, not downsizing
- Align with Weitj mission: Indigenous voices elevated through industry innovation ^[1]

NEXT STEPS & KEY DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

Immediate Action (This Week)

1. Send Research Brief + Demo Link (No Meeting Required)

- 1-page visual summary highlighting strategic gaps, ROI benchmarks (Sevenoaks pilot), and "Handsome Catering" agent demo link
- Frame as "read this in 5 minutes, test the agent in 2 minutes, reply if you want it live before Christmas"
- Send via WhatsApp (not email) to break pattern—higher open rate for busy founders

2. Set 7-Day Response Deadline

- If no response within 7 days, send single follow-up: "Gerry—last call. Demo link expires Friday. If timing's wrong, no worries—I'll circle back Q1 2026."

- If still no response, **deprioritize and redirect effort** to Sevenoaks, Maana Living, or new high-conversion pilots

Key Discovery Questions (If Engagement Resumes)

Operational:

- "What's your biggest month for missed calls or lost bookings?" (quantify pain point)
- "Where are you currently losing orders: after-hours, dietary inquiries, wholesale follow-ups?" (prioritize use case)
- "Who on your team would own day-to-day pilot management?" (identify internal champion)

Strategic:

- "Which upcoming tender or contract would benefit most from proven AI/digital capability?" (link to immediate opportunity)
- "Have you explored WA digital transformation grants or Indigenous business co-funding?" (de-risk investment)
- "What's the #1 admin task you wish you could offload?" (personal hook for Gerry)

Technical:

- "What phone system/CRM do you currently use?" (integration scoping)
- "Any cultural protocols or data sovereignty concerns we should embed upfront?" (PRIS Act compliance)^[4]

Cultural/Trust:

- "Would you prefer this positioned as commercial pilot, grant-funded project, or long-term partnership?" (frame relationship)

TIMELINE

Week	Action	Owner	Success Indicator
Week 1 (Now)	Send research brief + demo link via WhatsApp; no meeting required	You	Message delivered + read receipt
Week 1 (Day 5)	Single follow-up: "Demo link expires Friday—last chance before Christmas surge"	You	Response received (yes/no/timing)
Week 2	If yes: 10-minute remote onboarding call to scope integration	You + Gerry/Ops Lead	Internal champion identified; phone system details confirmed
Week 2-3	Deploy "GatherVoice" agent for Gather Foods (bookings, events, wholesale)	You	Agent live, internal team testing
Week 4	Baseline data collection: call volume, missed bookings, admin hours	Gather Foods team	Metrics documented (pre-AI baseline)

Week	Action	Owner	Success Indicator
Week 5-6	AI performance monitoring; iterate based on feedback	You + Internal Champion	30%+ missed call reduction achieved
Week 7+	Expand to Eon Protection, Indigenous Defence Services, Gather Foundation (Phase 2)	You + Gather Team	Multi-entity deployment live

Critical Path:

If no response by **Week 2**, deprioritize and revisit Q1 2026 (post-event season, post-holiday).

FINAL RECOMMENDATION

RECOMMENDATION: SEND RESEARCH BRIEF + DEMO IMMEDIATELY, THEN WAIT 7 DAYS MAX

Rationale:

Gather Foods/Weitj Investments is the **highest-value, best-aligned pilot** in your portfolio—perfect strategic fit, mission alignment, conglomerate scale, and cultural impact. Your research directly exposes operational/strategic gaps Gerry likely knows exist but hasn't prioritized fixing. The "we need to talk" message last week signals **latent interest**, but repeated ghosting pattern proves **execution risk is extreme**.

Your job offer history and personal relationship give you rare access—but only if you convert it to action NOW, before the Christmas event season buries Gerry's attention for 8+ weeks.

Action Plan:

1. **Send 1-page research brief + "Handsome Catering" demo link via WhatsApp today** (not email—higher open rate for busy founders)
2. **Frame as "no meeting required—read in 5 min, test in 2 min, reply if you want it live before Christmas"**
3. **Set 7-day response deadline**—if no reply, send single follow-up ("last call, demo expires Friday")
4. **If still no response by Week 2, STOP and deprioritize**—redirect effort to Sevenoaks, Maana Living, or new pilots with higher engagement momentum

Why This Approach Works:

- **Removes meeting friction** (biggest obstacle for busy founders)
- **Proof-first, pitch-second** (demo validates your technical execution, countering "all talk" perception)
- **Urgency framing** ("before Christmas surge") creates natural deadline
- **Research brief "slaps" him with strategic insight** (proves you're smarter/more valuable than he may assume)

- **7-day deadline protects your time** (no indefinite "exploratory" trap)

If Engagement Converts:

This pilot becomes your **flagship case study**—WA Aboriginal conglomerate, multi-entity deployment, PRIS-compliant, grant-funded, sector PR, and personal mission fulfilled. Worth the high-touch effort.

If Engagement Fails:

You've invested 1 day max (brief + demo + 2 follow-ups), proven the value proposition exists, and protected yourself from indefinite "waiting game." Revisit Q1 2026 when seasonal crunch ends and Gerry has bandwidth.

SATURATION & BARRIER ASSESSMENT

- ▯ **RED FLAG:** Engagement risk is **VERY HIGH**—repeated ghosting despite interest signals and personal relationship
- ▯ **YELLOW FLAG:** Digital maturity is **LOW-MEDIUM**—may require more change management than other pilots
- ▯ **GREEN FLAG: ZERO market saturation** for WA/Aboriginal-led, PRIS-compliant voice automation—massive first-mover advantage
- ▯ **GREEN FLAG: Perfect mission/strategic alignment**—this pilot is why you started Good AI Australia
- ▯ **GREEN FLAG: Conglomerate scale = 4+ use cases**—compounding ROI if execution succeeds

Bottom Line: Highest potential, highest risk. Worth one final, high-impact push—but set hard boundaries to protect your time and focus.

Data Gaps/Unknowns:

- Current phone system/CRM (integration scoping)
- Identity of operational champion (who owns day-to-day pilot management if Gerry unavailable?)
- Baseline call volume/missed booking metrics (quantify pain point)
- Grant application status or upcoming tender deadlines (immediate opportunity hooks)

If pilot activates, these gaps close quickly. If engagement stalls again, gaps are irrelevant—move on. ^[15] ^[16] ^[5] ^[7] ^[17] ^[6] ^[12] ^[14] ^[10] ^[1] ^[2] ^[4]

✱✱

1. <https://weitjinvestments.au>

2. <https://au.linkedin.com/in/gerry-matera-5072659a>

3. <https://weitjinvestments.au/portfolio/gather-foundation/>

4. <https://theibr.com.au/16-09-2025/20286/ken-wyatt-to-lead-gather-foundation-board>

5. <https://www.instagram.com/p/DPIS6eHCMxE/>

6. <https://www.facebook.com/gatherfoodswa/videos/gather-foundation-gala-making-fire-themed-around-creating-fire-the-evening-featu/1369349701289241/>

7. <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DQL7Bu8D3bw/>
8. <https://gatherfoods.com.au>
9. <https://www.atdw.com.au/marketplace/6842937751c9fa83224cf47b>
10. SME-Template-Analysis.pdf
11. <https://digiqt.com/blog/voice-agents-in-food-delivery/>
12. 10212025-Good-AI-Australia-voice-final.pdf
13. https://www.wa.gov.au/system/files/2023-03/Western_Australian_Investment_and_Trade_Plan_2022-24.pdf
14. <https://www.perplexity.ai/search/3ab9ce06-ab21-42fa-b4f3-ded61b3cb1ea>
15. <https://www.perplexity.ai/search/c98f83ad-a844-41ee-bc45-8b5fe50a8191>
16. <https://www.perplexity.ai/search/925c1da8-effe-4dbb-b776-344af3bb1310>
17. Trellit-Cheatsheet.docx
18. <https://cciwa.com/business-toolbox/employees/dealing-with-aggressive-customers/>
19. <https://cciwa.com/business-pulse/japanese-business-looking-for-opportunities-in-wa/>
20. <https://www.feed7generations.org/events>
21. <https://www.facebook.com/gatherandgourmetau/>
22. <https://www.nativegrownandgathered.com>
23. <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DPiGXt4CZOa/>
24. <https://nwrockymountainregionalfoodbusiness.com/event/native-grown-gathered-food-expo/>
25. <https://thefold.com.au/wa/perth-region/perth-perth-region/event/community-events/gather-gourmet/>
26. <https://growthshuttle.com/wesfarmers-ltd-a-closer-look-at-australias-diversified-conglomerate/>
27. <https://naahillahee.org/events/upcoming-partner-events/>
28. <https://investandtrade.wa.gov.au>
29. <https://www.feed7generations.org/programsandservices>
30. https://www.instagram.com/p/DQGapw9E_iF/
31. <https://wainvestments.com.au>
32. <https://www.itcmi.org/event/tahoma-peak-solutions-native-grown-gathered-food-expo/>
33. <https://www.dfat.gov.au/sites/default/files/invested-southeast-asia-economic-strategy-2040.pdf>